

UBC SUS presents....



science SURVIVAL guide

26/27 edition

Gain insight on navigating
academics, career
planning, and student life
in UBC Science

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how to PLAY ALONG

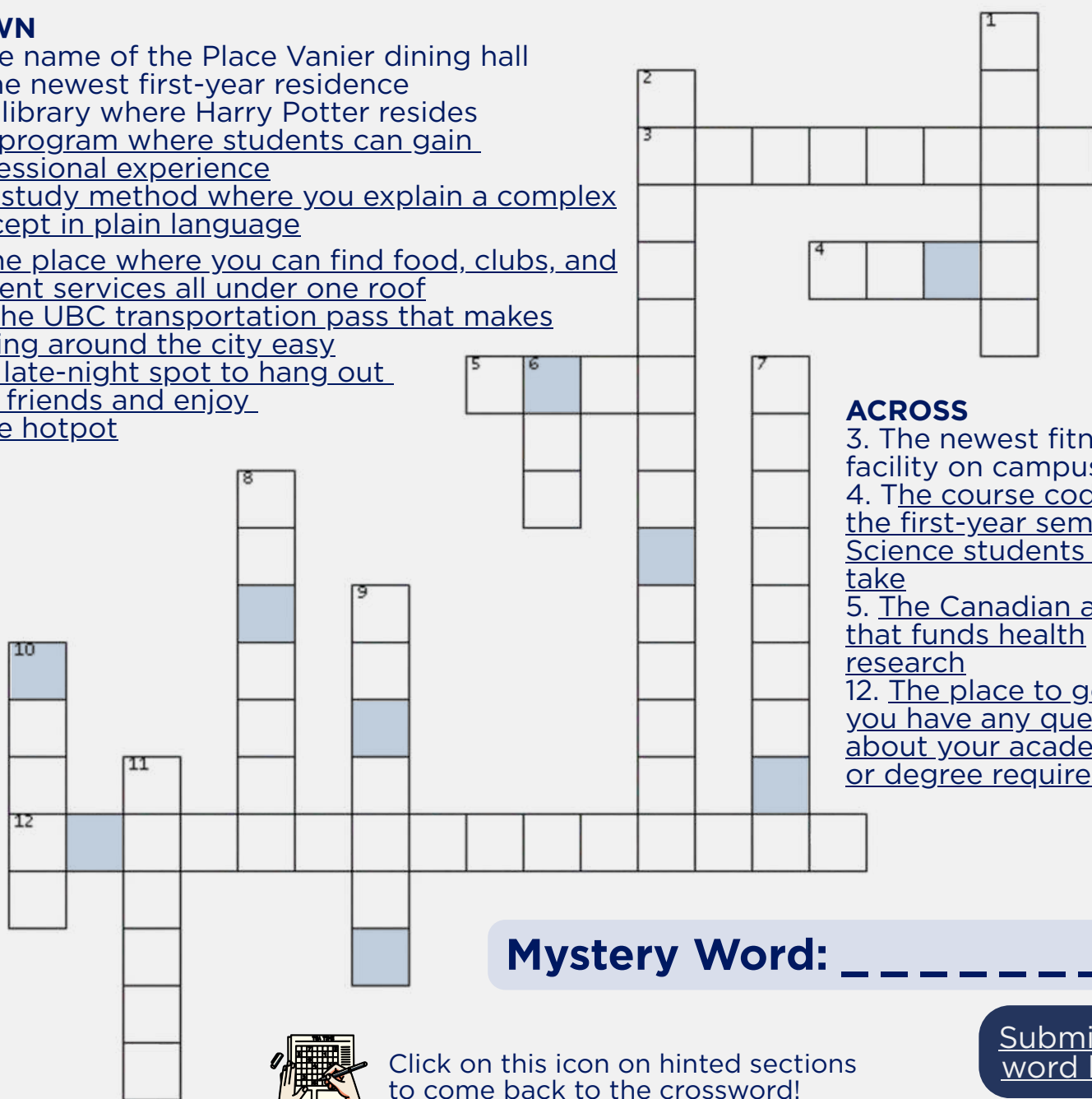
Solve all 12 clues and fill in the crossword below (no spaces between words). Once you've completed the puzzle, look at the highlighted boxes. The letters in these boxes will reveal a mystery word. **Submit the word by October 4th at 11:59 PM for chance to win a prize!**

DOWN

1. The name of the Place Vanier dining hall
2. The newest first-year residence
6. A library where Harry Potter resides
7. A program where students can gain professional experience
8. A study method where you explain a complex concept in plain language
9. The place where you can find food, clubs, and student services all under one roof
10. The UBC transportation pass that makes getting around the city easy
11. A late-night spot to hang out with friends and enjoy some hotpot

ACROSS

3. The newest fitness facility on campus
4. The course code for the first-year seminar all Science students must take
5. The Canadian agency that funds health research
12. The place to go if you have any questions about your academics or degree requirements



Mystery Word: _ _ _ _ _



Click on this icon on hinted sections to come back to the crossword!

**Submit the
word here!**

transitioning to **UNIVERSITY**

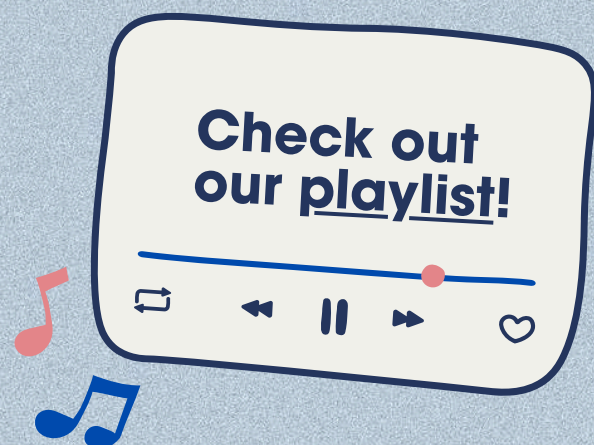
01

- 1. tips for commuting
- 2. life in residence
- 3. finding housing after first year
- 4. tips for social life

tips for COMMUTING

Making the Most of Your Commute

- Use your commute time to review lecture slides, complete pre-readings, or study with flashcards
- Listening to music or podcasts can help make longer commutes more enjoyable



Where can I find microwaves on campus?

- 📍 AMS Nest: Basement, Ground Floor (next to Honour Roll), Second Floor (near Hatch Art Gallery), Fourth Floor
- 📍 Neville Scarfe: Basement Student Lounge
- 📍 Pharmaceutical Sciences Building: First Floor



Find the closest microwave to heat up your meal between classes, but keep in mind that some locations may be busier than others!



Commuter Resources



Whether you're commuting from near or far, UBC offers many resources to help you stay connected and make the most of campus life.



- **UBC Collegia** provides first-year commuter students with study spaces, kitchen facilities, Wifi, and more across six locations! Register if you're interested!
- **UPass**: Activate your UPass for unlimited public transit during the school year! Since it's included in everyone's student fees (some exemptions apply), take advantage of it!
- **Commuter Student Hostel** offers affordable overnight accommodation for students who need a place to stay during exam season or for other campus activities. Reservations must be made online at least 24 hours in advance.



"Try not to take any early classes if your commute is far! You may be able to handle it for the first few weeks but burnout can be hard.

To try to save money for parking, you can try parking in areas by West 10th and take the bus for the rest of the way to UBC.

You can get some of the best studying time while you're transiting, especially on the train if it's empty

Go to collegia! Building community as a commuter can be hard so use your resources to your best advantage, as every commuter can sign up for collegia for free"



life in RESIDENCE

Living With a Roommate

- Have a conversation early about cleaning expectations, guest/visitor protocols, and other shared responsibilities
- Sharing your class schedules can also help you understand each other's routines!
- Know who your RA is and contact them when roommate/floor issues arise

Residence Resources



Free **fitness rooms** in each residence commonsblock!

Laundry space, especially on weekends, is highly coveted! Set a timer and avoid leaving your clothes unattended!



Printers are available in each residence commonsblock and in libraries around campus! They are all connected to the Pay-for-Print website, which allows you to print using money from your student card.



Sign out **game and sports equipment** from the front desk at your residence commonsblock! They are open from 7am to 11pm every day.

Attend **residence events**! Look out for posters and announcements for upcoming activities in floor lounges and commonsblocks.

Make your room feel like home with posters, photos, and decorations!



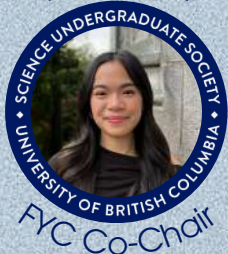
DORM ESSENTIALS

- ☐ Laundry bag + detergent
- ☐ Twin XL sheets + pillow
- ☐ Comforter + duvet cover
- ☐ Shower caddy + towels
- ☐ Clothes hangers



"Residence was a different experience than anything I had ever done. It was a shared experience of navigating a new life while balancing academics, a social life, and relationships. My biggest takeaway from living on res is to be vulnerable and to be open to any conversation. It deepens and strengthens your relationships with your neighbours and roommates. The best time I had was during my time in house council and I would recommend joining as it allowed me to connect with more people outside of my floor and connect with my community."

Koey Lau



finding HOUSING after first year



On Campus

**APPLY FOR YEAR
ROUND HOUSING
ASAP**



- Available to students after first year, on a **waitlist** basis
- **Highly competitive**
- Most students do not get an offer until third year
 - Shared residences have shorter wait times

Submit a **roommate request** to live with friends, but different application times may reduce your chances of receiving the same offer

Contact UBC Student Housing Services for more information

Off Campus

- Look into housing options early, since it can be competitive
- Consider living with roommates to lower rent costs
 - Have clear guidelines on budget, length of stay, and other expectations before deciding on a place!
- Common areas to rent:
 -  Wesbrook Village
 -  Kitsilano
 -  Dunbar

Consider commute time, not only rent!

tips for SOCIAL life



A new beginning isn't always easy, but it's a great opportunity to meet so many amazing people. Most people around you are equally nervous about making new friends, so don't be afraid to start the conversation!

Icebreakers to try:

What do you want to major in?

What's your go-to cafe order?

What's your favourite hobby?

Meeting New People

- **Ask people to eat together:** sharing a meal is a great way to start conversations and get to know people.
 - Ask a stranger if it is okay to sit with them in the dining hall
 - Invite people to try a food place on campus with you
- **Find a lecture buddy** to discuss iClicker questions with and study with!
- **Attend club icebreaker events!** These are great for meeting people who share your interests.

• Study in first year spaces:



Residence lounges or commonsblocks

Collegia

Vantage College classrooms in Orchard

- Studying in common spaces can provide opportunities for meeting and connecting with other first-years!

Campus Activities

- **Explore clubs** related to your hobbies, sports, career, and academic interests!
 - Visit the [AMS Club Directory](#) or talk to club representatives during Campus Life Expo
 - Follow clubs on Instagram to stay up to date with meetings and events
 - Consider applying for club positions to get more involved!

See Getting Involved section for more!

- Attend **UBC Thunderbirds** games
- Join an intramurals sports team

"Honestly, the transition from high school to university was hard. I was a commuter student and a lost first-year. Looking back, I missed out on chances to grow my social circle, sticking with the same friends from high school instead of putting myself out there. Love them to death, but don't be like first-year Issac! Whether you're commuting or living in residence, there are so many ways to meet people, you just have to take that first step. Apply to that club from the clubs fair, go to first-year events like the ones run by the First Year Committee, and follow pages like SUS to stay in the loop. When you RSVP, actually go. Talk to people, grab their contact, and follow up. Somewhere in there, you'll find your 4lifers!"



getting **INVOLVED**

02

- 1. community involvement
- 2. finding research opportunities
- 3. ubc bucket list

community INVOLVEMENT



Volunteering on Campus

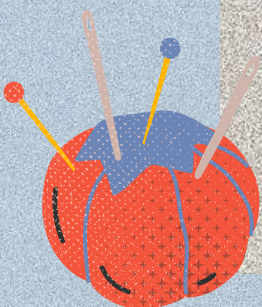
- Volunteering is a great way to develop new skills, meet people, and make an impact!
- UBC has tons of opportunities making it easy to find a role that matches your interests and goals!
 - **UBC Hospital:** support patients and staff through Vancouver Coastal health.
 - **Agora Café:** gain hands-on-food preparation and customer service experience.
- Explore the [Leadership and Volunteering page](#) or volunteer through clubs!



Clubs



- There are an endless number of clubs for students to get involved in, ranging from dance to sewing to science case studies.
- Learn about these clubs through the [AMS directory](#) or find their booth at club's day!



Science Undergraduate Society



- For **first years**, apply to join the **first year committee**. It's a great way to make connections and build organizational and leadership skills!
- The bulk of the hiring process for positions of other years happens during the summer in **May and June**.
- Fall hiring happens in **September**, and elections for VP positions happen during **March and April**.
- SUS committees host **tons of different events** ranging from networking to pet therapy. Some even have chances to win some amazing prizes.



SUS Events

Follow SUS
on Instagram
[@susubc!](https://www.instagram.com/susubc)

- **Pizza & Profs:** A professor panel for networking and learning about lab opportunities!
- **Science Week:** A week-long celebration to start Term 2, filled with many exciting events.
- **SUS Research Conference:** A new initiative to highlight undergrad student research.
- **Ignite:** A one-day professional conference to connect students to diverse career paths!
- **Upper Year Survival:** A way to get helpful degree advice from upper-year students



"I'm Katherine, President of the UBC Science Undergraduate Society. I've held various positions in SUS and other non-profits leading up to this role and genuinely believe getting involved on campus is imperative to a student's overall wellbeing. The friends and leadership skills you gain are invaluable and will stay with you through life. A bit of advice for those looking to get involved: Sometimes it might feel like opportunities are out of reach or you aren't "ready" yet to apply... Just apply! You don't know unless you try. I have felt like this numerous times in the past, but I always find I eventually grow into new roles and learn lots of new things. I have personally found the SUS Mentorship program and attending events really helpful in my junior years and would advise incoming students to get out to events, learn, make friends, and have fun!"



finding RESEARCH opportunities

Work Learn

Check out [UBC worklearn](#).

- Excellent way to gain experience in research and labs.
- Applications open on the [UBC Careers online](#).
- Employers ask for resumes and cover letters. Use [UBC resume and cover letter guide](#).
- The winter work term is **Sept 1st to April 30th** and summer work term is **May 1st to Aug 30th**.
- Apply to many applications, though remember to keep the quality of your application.
- Positions are often competitive thus applying early is preferred.

Check out [Science Co-op](#).

Science Co-op

- Offers students a chance to gain hands-on, paid work experience in their field before graduation.
- A wide range of job postings, from industry roles to academic research positions.
- Be sure to track application deadlines carefully (check the official [Science Co-op Deadlines](#) page).
- If you are interested, be sure to attend the info sessions which can be found on [Science co-op website](#). You can also contact science co-op through email (science.coop@ubc.ca).



For labs, check the
[undergraduate research](#)
[webpage](#)

Cold Emailing

- It is best to reach out to professors/researchers whose work speaks to you and aligns with your interests.
- Ask your professors about potential opportunities! Office hours are a great opportunity
 - (Tip: positions tend to fill up very fast, so contact professors months ahead of when you want to begin).
- Make sure to personalize the email by researching the professor's lab work and websites to show interest.



Sample Email

Dear Dr. Banner,

I hope this email finds you well as summer approaches. My name is Peter Parker, and I've just completed my second year at UBC as an honours student in CAPS.

As an aspiring developmental biologist, I've been particularly interested in your work in stem cell therapies and aging. I would love for a chance to learn more about your research in [insert research topic or a paper you read from that prof], and am inquiring about any volunteer opportunities related to this area.

I've attached my resume and unofficial transcript for your consideration, and I would be happy to provide any additional information if needed. Thank you very much for your time, and I look forward to the possibility of speaking to you.

Sincerely,
Peter Parker



URO's Research Experience Program (REX)

- Undergraduate Research Opportunities (URO) provides opportunities for students to work with a mentor on a research project
- Will be presented at the Multidisciplinary Undergraduate Research Conference (MURC) through REX.
- Applications open at the beginning of semester one, and MURC presentations occur in March. Find more information on how to apply and start working with a mentor on the [URO Instagram page](#)

Check [UBC undergrad awards page](#)



NSERC & CIHR Awards



- Research awards offer paid summer research opportunities for domestic undergraduate students.
- These competitive awards let you work full-time in a research lab under the supervision of a UBC faculty member.
- Be sure to check eligibility criteria specific to the Faculty of Science, and reach out to professors ahead of time, as applications are due months before the summer. Keep track of science specific information [here](#).



SUS Lab Tours

- SUS lab tours provide an excellent opportunity to get to know more about what research suits you the best.
- Get a behind-the-scenes look at cutting-edge research labs led by UBC Science professors, and learn how undergraduate students can join lab teams. Look out for tour opportunities on the SUS Instagram page!
- Be sure to sign up as soon as the opportunity comes, as spots are often limited.



Labs Visited

- Mizumoto Lab
- Abdelrahman Lab
- MacLachlan Group
- TRIUMF Lab
- The Jan Lab



"If you are interested in research but are not sure where to start, there are many opportunities for students who are just beginning to explore research. Programs like URO REX are a great way to learn what research can look like and explore different fields. Volunteering in a lab is another great option, so do not be afraid to cold email PIs whose work interests you. Try to reach out early and apply to a variety of opportunities rather than focusing on just one. Even if a position is not exactly what you imagined, it can still help you build useful skills, make connections, and discover new interests. Keep an open mind throughout the process as every experience can help you learn more about research and what interests you!"

Ivy Guo

ubc BUCKET LIST

Adventures

- ☐ **Midnight BigWay Hotpot** run with friends



- ☐ Going to the **UBC Botanical Gardens**



- ☐ Visiting **Nitobe Gardens** during the cherry blossom season



- ☐ Stand and speak on the **echo chamber**



- ☐ Taking a photo with our UBC mascot
Thunder the Thunderbird!



Adventures

- ☐ Recreate a **scene filmed** on UBC campus with your friends!



- ☐ Go on a **study crawl** and explore study spots at UBC



Events

- ☐ Join at least **one club**
- ☐ Attend the **homecoming football** game



- ☐ AMS block party + Calendar Halloween party



- ☐ Storm the wall



- ☐ Calendar **Polar Bear Dip**



Food must-try's

- ☐ Get a **surprise drink** at **Blue chip** with your favourite cookie
- ☐ Get a **sandwich** at **Great Dane** and chat with your peers at the sofas
- ☐ Make your **custom sauce** by trying different flavours at the dining hall
- ☐ Have a post midterm run to **rain and shine** to reward yourself!



Off-Campus Activities



BREKA



Granville island



Metrotown & Oakridge



Grouse Grind



Downtown Kitsilano



Seabus to Northvan



Visit Victoria



Biking @ Stanley

Ski/Snowboard in Whistler/Cypress



academic **SUCCESS**

03

- 1.study tips & strategies
- 2.popular courses & tips
- 3.degree planning

study tips & STRATEGIES

Resources for Academic Success

1) Science Advising

A Science student's primary resource for academic advising. Staff and academic advisors are there to assist undergrad students in their general academic planning, in interpreting faculty regulations and course requirements, and in resolving academic and personal problems.

2) Science Peer Academic Coaches

Struggling with study habits, time management, or academic stress? Chat with a Science Peer Academic Coach to set goals, discuss and brainstorm study habits to guide your approach in action moving forward.



3) Academic Integrity Hub

The Academic Integrity Hub has launched an updated "Academic Integrity Foundations" Canvas course to help you be thoroughly informed about policy definitions, misconduct consequences, upholding best practices, and essential campus support resources.

Study Spots to Try



[AMS Nest Room Bookings](#)



[Science Study Halls](#)



[UBC Library Room Bookings](#)

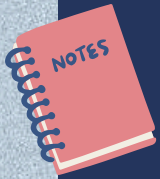


Try this unconventional study tip:

Challenge yourself to complete as much work as possible while your laundry is running!



Day-to-Day Study Tips



Review lecture material regularly: spend 5-10 minutes looking over your notes after lecture! This helps you retain the material and listen more actively next lecture.



Figure out when and where you study best: do you study better in the morning or evening, alone or with others, and at home or somewhere with less distractions?



Stay organized: use a digital or physical planner to keep track of deadlines and prioritize tasks



Group studying: study with a small group to quiz each other, stay accountable, and learn different approaches to concepts

Popular Notetaking Apps

GoodNotes

- Organized by folders
- Highly customizable
- Scribble to erase!

One time purchase + subscription options

Both popular, reliable options!

Notability

- More minimal
- Easy access through sidebar
- Quick to navigate
- Great for quick notetaking

Honourable mentions: Google Docs, OneNote, Notion

Studying for Midterms and Finals

- **Assess & plan:** identify challenging topics early and schedule study time accordingly
- **Summarize first:** condense notes into key concepts before applying them to practice problems
- **Simulate an exam-like environment** when you do the practice exams:



Practice in a populated space

Set a timer: Set a time shorter than the actual exam to simulate exam stress.



Review your practice exam: Understand why each answer is right or wrong, including why other options are incorrect. This builds pattern recognition and helps you adapt to unfamiliar exam questions.



Active Recall Study Methods



- Prioritize solving fresh practice problems over flashcards for problem-heavy subjects

Test yourself to build long neural pathways!

- Use the **Blurting Method:** dump everything you remember onto blank paper from memory, then check your notes to fill gaps.
- Apply the **Feynman Technique:** explain complex concepts in simple terms to spot gaps in your understanding.



Exam-Taking Strategies



Before You Start

Quick brain dump:

write tricky formulas, equations, and terms on your test page immediately.

Scan the test: take one minute to preview points and plan your time.

Take a breath: you've got this!

During the Test

Use the Two-Pass System:

- First Pass: answer easy questions first to secure quick points and build momentum.
- Second Pass: return to tackle harder questions with remaining time

Pace yourself: don't waste time on low-point questions. Keep moving!

How to Answer Different Questions

Multiple Choice **ABCD**

- **Predict first:** draft an answer mentally before looking at the choices to avoid distractor options

Short Answer

- **Lead with the answer:** put the direct answer first, using bullet points and diagrams for easy grading



Calculations

- **Show all work:** write out steps, formulas, and units clearly to secure partial credit.



If you get stuck...

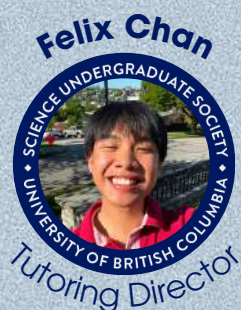
- **Check your units:** make sure your units line up correctly, this can give you a big hint on how to set up the math.
- **Never leave answers blank:** write down relevant formulas or definitions for partial marks.
- **Build confidence in your initial answers:** resist the urge to second-guess yourself at the end



You did it!

After Your Exam

- **Take a break:** give yourself time to rest before jumping back into studying
- **Reflect:** what went well and what might you do differently next time?



"For learning material, listening in class (really) and focusing on learning objectives after will save you TONS of time. Study with your friends, write concepts out BY HAND, and be honest with yourself when you don't get a concept (don't rely on answer keys!); this is when you can reach out for help, whether it be office hours or SUS tutoring! For motivation, find what works for YOU and don't compare yourself to others. Personally I find that a good snack and drink will do wonders. Try having 'low energy' study days (eg flashcards) to avoid burnout, and switch study spots for change of pace. Finally, don't be too hard on yourself: don't forget to enjoy your uni experience, explore the beautiful campus, and BE KIND TO YOURSELF!!"

popular COURSES

& tips

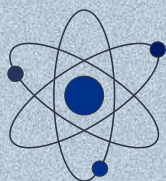
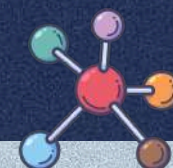


CHEM 121/123 Lecture Component

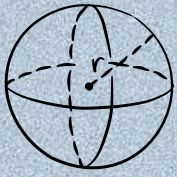
- Keep up with problems and redo them to prepare for MTs/Finals.
- Attend office hours to hear others' questions + clarify understanding.
- Explain concepts to peers to help reinforce understanding.

CHEM 121/123 Lab Component

- Check the canvas page frequently to ensure required items are completed prior to lab days.
- Take notes on each lab and review them for lab finals or help with lab reports/EDFs.



"The transition into first year undergraduate chemistry courses is challenging: the content pace is faster, the styles of questions vary, and the standards for showing mastery of content are higher. Most advice given can appear trite, but they are still incredibly helpful suggestions. Stay on top of content as much as possible by laying out a schedule of when you will work on problems/assignments, etc., even if they are not for marks. Ask for help, even if you are not sure what your confusion is, in office hours or the Resource Centre. Find study buddies to alleviate how much content you must explain to yourself. Learn from what you get wrong; it's one of the best ways to learn!"



$$V = \frac{4}{3} \pi r^3$$

BIOL 112/121

- Use problem sets to practise exam format; check answers after completing them.
- Use Learning Objectives as a review checklist.
- Ask profs/TAs for help connecting concepts and developing logical flow.



CPSC 103/110

- Make it a habit to save code and syntax (even when practicing).
- Make note of definitions and code not provided in date driven templates.
- Try to understand code, rather than memorizing the steps.

MATH 100/101

- Utilise past exams and textbook problems for trickier concepts.
- Try to observe patterns for CLP problems and work through each problem.
- Start group projects early and solve each problem as a group.

PHYS 117/131

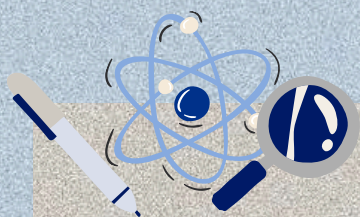
- Track new formulae derived in class + understand how to manipulate them.
- Create variations of problems by changing constraints/unknowns.
- Double-check your work and perform sanity checks on final values!



WRDS 150



- Actively engage in class discussions to understand class' theme and connect with your section's prof.
- Start solidifying research topic/content early
- If working with a group, clearly define the content/scope of each section.
- Take your pre-reads seriously, have some questions prepared beforehand for engagement in class.
- Focuses on rhetorics, section themes, and writing practices
- Topics vary by section



SCIE 113

NOTE: ALL B.Sc. students are required to receive credit for SCIE V 113

- Focuses on scientific inquiry, evidence, logical fallacies, overall communication
- Topics are usually similar across sections

Main Stream

- Participate in class + start early
- Pay close attention to the speaker series + keep track of topics. Each group will pick one for a final project.
- Start major assignments early
- Use office hours wisely

Science One

- Explore topics through term 1 to create a concrete project in term 2
- Plan methodology + anticipate corrections
- Complete the STL reflections right after class.

EOSC 114

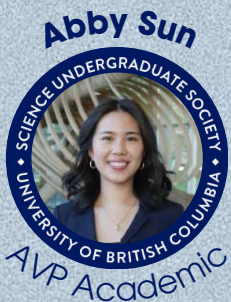


- Be prepared to actively read material, complete assignments, and employ study strategies
- Study in a group, if possible
- Use the learning objectives to base practice questions
- Past quizzes/exams are very helpful to prepare for tests
- Keep up with each module and test yourself throughout the course to adequately prepare for midterms.



ENGL 110/112

- Read actively, take note on symbols and connections to theme. Analyze authorial choices
- Start major assignments early
- Proofread aloud to work on your writings flow and to find any errors. Check citations!
- Edit well, in the following 3 steps: i) go over major errors , ii) go over structure, iii) minor grammar errors.
- Peer edit if possible
- Use office hours to refine ideas and get feedback



"Figuring out how you learn can be just as important as what you learn. Different courses have different structures, assessments, and expectations, so don't be afraid to adjust your study strategies instead of using the same approach for every class. Early in the term, think about your goals for the course and build habits that match them. More importantly, experiment with different methods until you find what works best for you— effective studying is a skill that develops over time!"

degree PLANNING

Registration



When?

- Registration windows vary by session, year, and student group; check **official UBC websites** and confirm on workday.
- There can be exemptions to these general policies, be sure to double check!
 - **All times are in PST.**
- Once your window opens, you can register until the **add/drop deadline.**

Where/How?

- Register through Workday; visit UBC's Workday Tutorial Page for additional guidance.
- Join waitlists for full courses and monitor your email for openings.
- Check prerequisites/corequisites; prerequisites must be completed first, while corequisites can be taken concurrently.

Specialization



Applications for admission into Science specializations open in the spring after your promotion to second-year standing.

For more information on promotional requirements, visit the [UBC Academic Calendar](#).

- Rank your **top 3** specializations - keep in mind some specializations consider rank placements in addition to averages.



Common Misunderstanding !!

Specialization eligibility and the UBC Academic Calendar requirements for first year are different. Not all of the Calendar requirements need to be fulfilled before applying to specialization!

Find more information about specialization [here!](#)

- Some majors are more competitive than others, so it's important to make informed choices when ranking your options. To get a better idea of admission trends, look at [historical admission averages](#).
- Beyond looking at the numbers, take time to learn about each major and gauge if it's a good fit for you:
 - Attend events like Meet Your Major and SUS Navigate Your Degree.
 - Ask upper-year students about their experiences!

Extra Resources

- 💡 **Wayfinding**: Determine the distances between buildings
- 💡 **UBC Workday Extension**: Access prof ratings, course averages, and term-by-term calendar views in one place
- 💡 **UBC Grades/UBC Finder**: View a grade breakdown per section for UBC courses and the historical averages

Course Planning



Visit the **UBC Academic Calendar (2026/27)** for the most updated information on courses, requirements, and deadlines. Here are some general requirements:

Communication

Lower-level

Upper-level

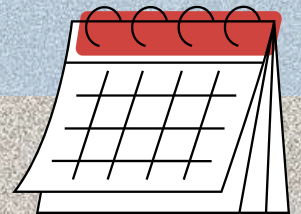
Science

Arts

Science Breadth

See **here** for additional breakdowns!

- Each major has additional requirements for progression to upper-level standing!
- This information can be found on the UBC Academic Calendar.



Tips for Choosing Courses

Summer Courses:

- Take electives that don't fit into your Winter schedule.
- Complete breadth/minor requirements.
- Fulfill missing prereqs.
- Take content-heavy courses, keeping in mind the accelerated pace.

Electives:

- Use electives to balance heavier courses, fulfill requirements, and explore topics you're interested in.
- "GPA boosters" are student-dependent, so take recommendations with a grain of salt.

Degree Planning

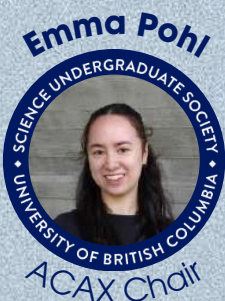


Visit the [UBC Academic Calendar](#) for a more comprehensive guide on degree types and options

Other Degree Options



- **Add a minor:** This can be a great way to hone in on a specific area of interest.
- **Honours:** Varies between specializations but typically allows for more intense scopes into subject areas.
- **Double Major:** Allows students to earn one degree with two distinct specializations.
- **Dual Degrees:** Combine your B.Sc with a B.A., B.Ed, B.Mus, or Master of Management (MM). These allow for a highly unique combination of study.
- **Co-op:** Allows students the opportunity to gain work experience within their degree.



"UBC's specialization process can be quite stressful, but balancing your course load helps a lot! I chunked my courses reasonably to schedule a day off or have a single-class day, which freed up time to study and get involved on campus. I also noted which courses genuinely interested me and as such focused more on specializations related to those courses."

"Keep track of your degree requirements! I felt less overwhelmed once I'd roughly planned out courses, and now I've found that I have more freedom for other electives. Overall, just don't panic! Even if you don't get the specialization, courseload, or outcome you'd hoped for, just take it as an opportunity to try something new and eventually, things will seem to fall into place!"

health & **WELLNESS**

04

- 1. tips for physical health
- 2. mental health support

tips for PHYSICAL Food health

Nutrition & Hydration

Good nutrition and hydration support focus, memory, mood, and overall well-being.

- Bring snacks so you can stay fueled in between meals!
- Choose balanced meals, limit processed foods, and stay hydrated.



Options

- Don't skip meals, especially if you have the **All Access Dining Plan**. The plan is applicable at each dining hall.
- Order dining hall meals ahead through **Nutrislice**.
- Check **Uber Eats** and nearby campus restaurants, including the international food court.

Dietary Restrictions

- Use Nutrislice to view menus and filter by allergens or dietary preferences.
- Inform dining staff of any allergies or intolerances before ordering.
- Residence students can contact the Residence Dietitian for support with allergies, intolerances, medical dietary needs, or nutrition questions.

Exercise



- Try to set a consistent exercise routine, getting a little bit of exercise every day.
- Use exercise as study breaks!
- Do a **study crawl**! Study at different spots across campus throughout the day, switching spots every couple of hours, and use the walk between spots as a break!



Group Options

- Join clubs such as run club, pilates club, yoga club, dance club, etc.
- Find them on Instagram!
 - @ubcrunningclub
 - @ubcyogaclub
 - @ubcpilatesclub
 - @ubcdancehorizons
- Join an intramural sport at the beginning of the semester. Find more info [here](#)!



Explore Facilities on Campus!

- UBC students can buy a discounted semester-long gym pass
- Aquatic Center and Thunderbird Sports Center have free drop-ins
- UBC Recreation has a **free week** with a whole bunch of different exercise classes to try.
- Try out the free fitness centers in residences!



Take Part in Special Events!

- **Day of the Longboat**: The largest voyageur canoe in the world on Jericho Beach.
- **Storm the Wall**: UBC's signature triathlon done in groups of 5.
- **Water Wars**: A fun filled night consisting of water based games and activities.
- **The Great Trek**: A race for everyone with a Half Marathon, 10KM and 5KM, plus a Hat-trick option with a bonus prize if you run all three races.



Sleep

Good sleep improves cognitive function, memory, and emotional well-being.



Getting into a rhythm can help you be so much more productive

- Try to get at least 7 hours of sleep per night
- Additional sleep tips can be found [here](#)!

"Staying active in university doesn't have to mean spending hours at the gym. Find movement you enjoy whether that's intramurals, walking to class, or working out with friends so it becomes part of your routine instead of another task on your to-do list. This is a time where you can explore what works best for you so don't be afraid to branch out and try new things. Remember that physical health is more than exercise, prioritize consistent sleep, stay hydrated, and have nutritious snacks on hand during busy weeks. Try not to be too hard on yourself if your routine shifts, remember that physical activity can look different each day. Taking care of your physical health will improve your energy, focus, and overall university experience!"

Frieda Bardhi &
Alycia Ma



support for MENTAL health

UBC offers free, confidential resources that are available to support you whenever you need.



Daily Tips

Mental health is deeply connected to physical health, and they directly influence one another. Protect your mental health in the following ways:

- **Sleep:** Aim for consistency to boost memory and focus.
- **Fuel & Hydrate:** Keep snacks and water nearby to sustain energy.
- **Move Outdoors:** Take 10-minute walks between classes to clear brain fog.

Campus and Community Resources

- **AMS Peer Support:** Free, confidential, one-on-one support run by trained UBC students. Great for talking through academic stress, loneliness, or life changes.
- **UBC Wellness Centre:** Drop in to chat with trained Peer Educators about managing workload, sleep, health, and navigating campus resources.

Equity, Safety, and Specialized Advocacy



- **Centre for Accessibility:** Coordinates academic accommodations for students with documented mental health conditions, ongoing illnesses, or disabilities.
- **Equity & Inclusion Office:** Resources, support, and advice regarding discrimination, harassment, and equity on campus.
- **Sexual Violence Prevention and Response Office (SVPRO):** Safe, confidential support for anyone affected by sexualized violence, regardless of when or where it took place.
 - Feel free to call **604-822-1588**

Reach out early! Struggling or feeling overwhelmed can happen. Reaching out early keeps small issues from compounding.

Manage Stress

- **Set Hard Stops:** Pick a nightly cutoff time to prevent burnout.
- **Use the 5-Minute Rule:** Start daunting tasks for just 5 minutes to build momentum.
- **Stay Connected:** Grab quick coffees with friends and reach out early for help when stuck.



Remember that a low grade does not reflect your intelligence or potential!

Professional Counselling & Clinical Care



- UBC Counselling Services: Connect with a Wellness Advisor for a same-day initial assessment to build a personalized care plan (group sessions, workshops, or one-on-one therapy).
- UBC Student Health Service: Provides primary medical care, including consultations with doctors and nurse practitioners for mental health assessments or medication management.

Crisis Hotlines & 24/7 Support

- **Emergency (911)**
- **Call/text Suicide Crisis Helpline (988)**
- **Here2Talk (1-877-857-3397)**: Free student mental health counseling via phone, app, or chat.
- **Hope for Wellness (1-855-242-3310)**: Crisis support for Indigenous students.
- **UBC Campus Security (604-822-2222)**: Campus assistance and safety escorts.



Academic Concession

If an unexpected emergency, severe illness, or major conflict prevents you from writing a final exam, you may be eligible for an academic concession.

For more information and eligibility guidelines [visit the Science Advising website.](#)



Prayer & Reflection Spaces



UBC supports an inclusive campus environment by offering dedicated multi-faith spaces for personal prayer, meditation, and quiet reflection throughout the Vancouver campus.

Dedicated Campus Locations

- AMS Prayer Space in the AMS Student Nest
- Brock Commons South Multifaith Prayer and Quiet Contemplation Room
- Wesbrook Building Prayer Room
- West Mall Swing Space Prayer Room
- **Residence Spaces:** Multi-faith and prayer rooms are also available within select campus residences (such as Marine Drive).
- For more information, exact room schedules, and campus location maps, visit [their website](#) or check the [AMS Student Nest Directory](#).



"As science students, we know it's easy to get caught up in classes and put mental health on the back burner. Habits like sleep help us too! As students who have surpassed first year, we know how tough it can be to find your niche and adjust to a lifestyle where academics take up a part of your life. Succeeding in a course doesn't just come down strictly to knowledge, it comes through balance and mindset. Helpful habits include office hours, setting aside time to study, and using free study resources (e.g. Anki, Goodnotes, AMS tutoring, SUS tutoring, Organic Chemistry Tutor etc.), and most importantly getting exercise and connecting with nature - these little habits can boost your serotonin and dopamine levels, keeping you going for the day!"



meet the ACAX TEAM

2026/2027

ACAX CO-CHAIR

Heta Patel: NEURO YR 3



Food Spot: Rain or Shine

AVP ACADEMIC

Abby Sun: NEURO YR 4



Food Spot: Rain or Shine

VP ACADEMIC

Annie Wang: CAPS YR 5



Food Spot: Great Dane

ACAX CO-CHAIR

Emma Pohl: CAPS YR 3



Food Spot: Steve's Poke

Coordinators

Aashita Goyal: CAPS YR2



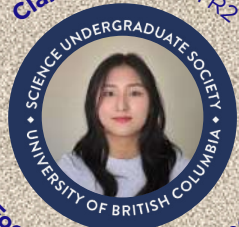
Food Spot: Great Dane

Anson Ng: CAPS YR3



Food Spot: Subway

Clara Suh: BIOL YR2



Food Spot: Bigway Hotpot

Jason Lee: NEURO YR3



Food Spot: Triple O's

Joyce He: BIOC YR3



Food Spot: Kung Fu Noodle

Chris Huh: ISCI YR4



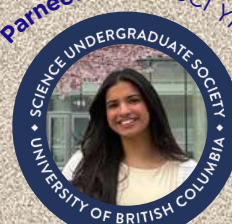
Food Spot: Triple O's

Marcelino Magar: ISCI YR3



Food Spot: Kinton Ramen

Parneet Dhesi: ISCI YR2



Food Spot: Chipotle